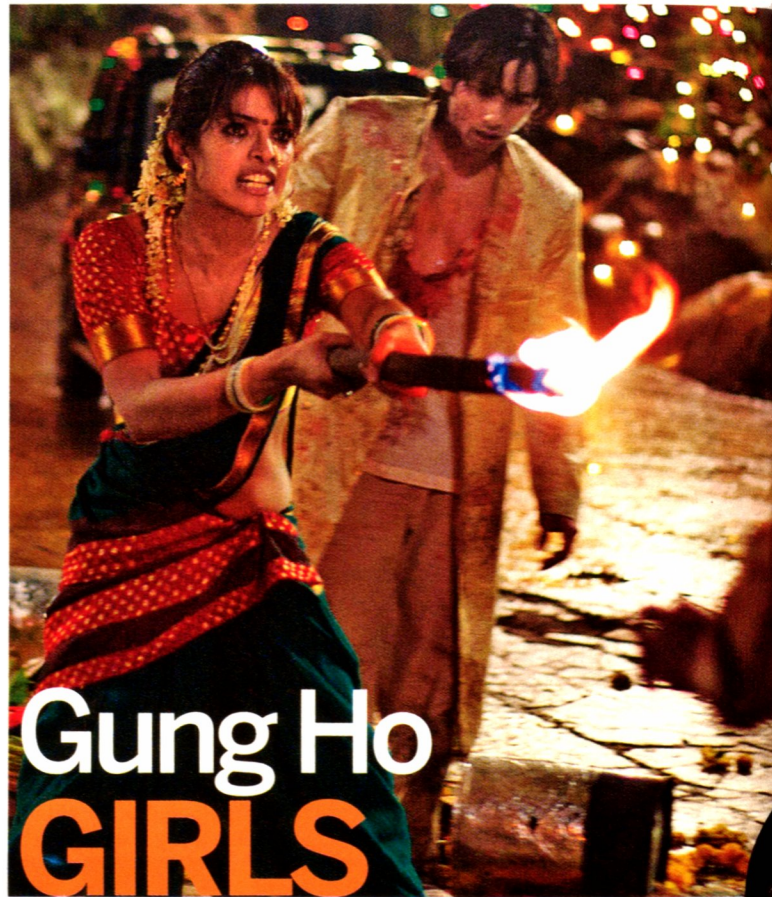


| By Kaveree Bamzai |

There bade baal hain," says Paro to Dev when she has managed to disrobe him in the middle of a field on a mattress she has carried with herself on a cycle. "We left it to the imagination of the audience what hair we were talking about," says Mahie Gill from Chandigarh who played the role in Anurag Kashyap's *Dev.D*. In the forthcoming *Kambakkht Ishq*, Kareena Kapoor says to Akshay Kumar, "You're a filthy, uneducated lout," while at another point, she kneels him in the groin. "She's an intellectual snob and thinks love, especially with a stuntman like Akshay is a waste of time," says the film's writer Anvita Dutt Guptan. And in yet another summer movie, *Kaminey*, Priyanka Chopra, playing a middle-class Maharashtrian girl, shouts at her husband, when he protests about her pregnancy: "To kya maine tumhara rape kiya?" "She's a firecracker who wears the pants in the relationship," says the film's associate director Supratik Sen.

Elsewhere too women are being snarky, getting physical and sometimes downright aggressive. Take Palak (Gurmeet Johal), one of the three finalists from the just-wrapped *MTV Roadies 6.0*. She wrestled with a WWE professional in Australia, jumped all over another contestant Tamanna until she was dragged off and regularly yelled expletives that had to be bleeped. Or even Jesse Randhawa in the Bajaj ad who kicks, punches and tears Lisa Haydon's hair in the twisted sisters commercial because she wants a ride on the XCD 135.

Who are these women, confident, assured, and often even over the top? Well, from all around us actually, says MTV Vice-President Ashish Patil. "Girls are evolving into what boys were a few years ago," he says. So not only do they have a greater sense of entitlement than the generation before, but they have also begun to lead alternative lives, often aided by technology, and become more experi-



Gung Ho GIRLS

Women on film and TV have gone from being stomped upon to stompers as they flex their freedom muscles

mental about their sexuality. So like Chanda in *Dev.D*, which was based on the real life Delhi schoolgirl who was caught in an SMS scandal, they can go from riding a scooty to college in the morning to talking dirty on the phone for money in the evening. Or they are merely flaunting their sexuality to get ahead in life, the basis of MTV's utterly perverse *Splitsville 2*, where exchange of abuse between the girls has now become so bad that the contestants' mouths have to be pixellated. Or even like Sonam Kapoor's character in *Delhi-6*, who spends time in a pho-

► KAREENA KAPOOR, SIMRITA IN *KAMBAKHT ISHQ* AN INDEPENDENT LOS ANGELES GIRL WHO HAS PAID HER WAY THROUGH COLLEGE, BELIEVES MEN GET IN THE WAY OF A GREAT CAREER